

LOOKING BACK Rehmat *means compassion, the theme that unites the four short stories in the film*

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IN SEARCH OF COMPASSION

Director GURVINDER SINGH opens up about his feature *Rehmat* and navigating Punjab's complex history

Through his acclaimed body of work, including *Anhey Ghorhey Da Daan* (2011), *Chauthi Koot* (2015) and *Adh Chanani Raat* (2022), director Gurvinder Singh has explored Punjab's sociopolitical landscape. His latest feature, *Rehmat*, which was screened at the Dharamshala International Film Festival (DIFF) 2026 following its world premiere at the 79th Locarno Film Festival in August, builds on this ongoing conversation.

Rehmat weaves together four short stories written by author Ajeet Cour and constructs a cinematic narrative about Punjab's history of migrations, conflict and societal shifts. The narrative follows a woman who secretly harbours a wounded stranger in her house while his family grapples with overwhelming grief and agonising decisions. Elsewhere, the rhythm of a village is disrupted by the arrival of an enigmatic elderly man who claims to be God.

"*Rehmat* means compassion. The title came out of a

NOT BECAUSE IT'S EASY Genden Phuntsok (Tenzing Norgay) and Tom Hiddleston (Edmund Hillary)



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Climb Every Mountain

Actor GENDEN PHUNTSOK brings warmth and charm to this biopic of Tenzing Norgay and his ascent of Everest

It's a Tenzing Norgay show all the way in Australian filmmaker Jennifer Peedom's biopic about the Sherpa herder who became the first man to climb Mount Everest with New Zealander Edmund Hillary.

A charming lead performance from Genden Phuntsok playing the adult Norgay, alongside another charmer from Teznin Dalha, playing a slightly younger version when he joins his first Everest expedition, makes the predictable film immensely watchable.

Born in Tibet, Norgay is shown to be belonging to Bhotia stock. He is not part of the Sherpas, who routinely

CAPTIVATED BY THE SUMMIT AS A YOUNG HERDER, THE TIBETAN NORGAY JOINED BRITISH CLIMBERS FOR THE 1953 ASCENT